

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

1. Introduction

Project Title: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Team ID: SWTID-2026-6064

Team Members:

Team Member 1:

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2. Project Overview

Purpose:

The purpose of this project is to streamline the IT procurement process for standard laptop orders using ServiceNow Flow Designer. The existing process involves manual intervention for creating and assigning laptop configuration tasks after a request is approved. This can result in delays, missed tasks, increased manual workload, and inefficient resource utilisation. The proposed solution automates the process so that after a Standard Laptop request is approved, a Catalog Task is automatically created and assigned to the Hardware group for laptop configuration.

Features:

- Standard Laptop request through the Service Catalog.
- Automated approval-based workflow.
- Flow Designer automation.
- Automatic creation of a Catalog Task.
- Automatic assignment of the task to the Hardware group.
- Automatic update of the task short description.
- Automatic update of the task description.
- Approval status set to Approved.
- Integration of the flow with the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.
- Reduced manual intervention.
- Improved task allocation and processing efficiency.

3. Architecture

ServiceNow Platform

The project is implemented within the ServiceNow platform using Service Catalog and Flow Designer.

Service Catalog → Standard Laptop Request → Approval → Flow Designer → Create Catalog Task → Hardware Assignment → Laptop Configuration

Flow Designer

The main automation component is a Global Flow named “Standard Laptop Task”. The flow is configured to:

1. Run as System user.
2. Use a Service Catalog trigger.
3. Receive the Requested Item Record.
4. Create a Catalog Task.
5. Set the short description as “Laptop need to Configured”.
6. Set the description as “Laptop need to Configured”.
7. Set the Assignment Group as Hardware.
8. Set the Approval value as Approved.

Service Catalog

The Standard Laptop Service Catalog item is connected to the Standard Laptop Task flow. When a user places a Standard Laptop order, the request can proceed through the approval process. After approval, the configured flow creates the required Catalog Task.

Task Management

The generated Catalog Task is assigned to the Hardware group. The Hardware team can then use the task to perform the required laptop configuration.

4. Setup Instructions

Prerequisites

- Access to a ServiceNow instance.
- Appropriate ServiceNow user access.
- Access to Flow Designer.
- Access to Service Catalog.
- Access to Maintain Items.
- Access to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.
- Permission to create and activate flows.

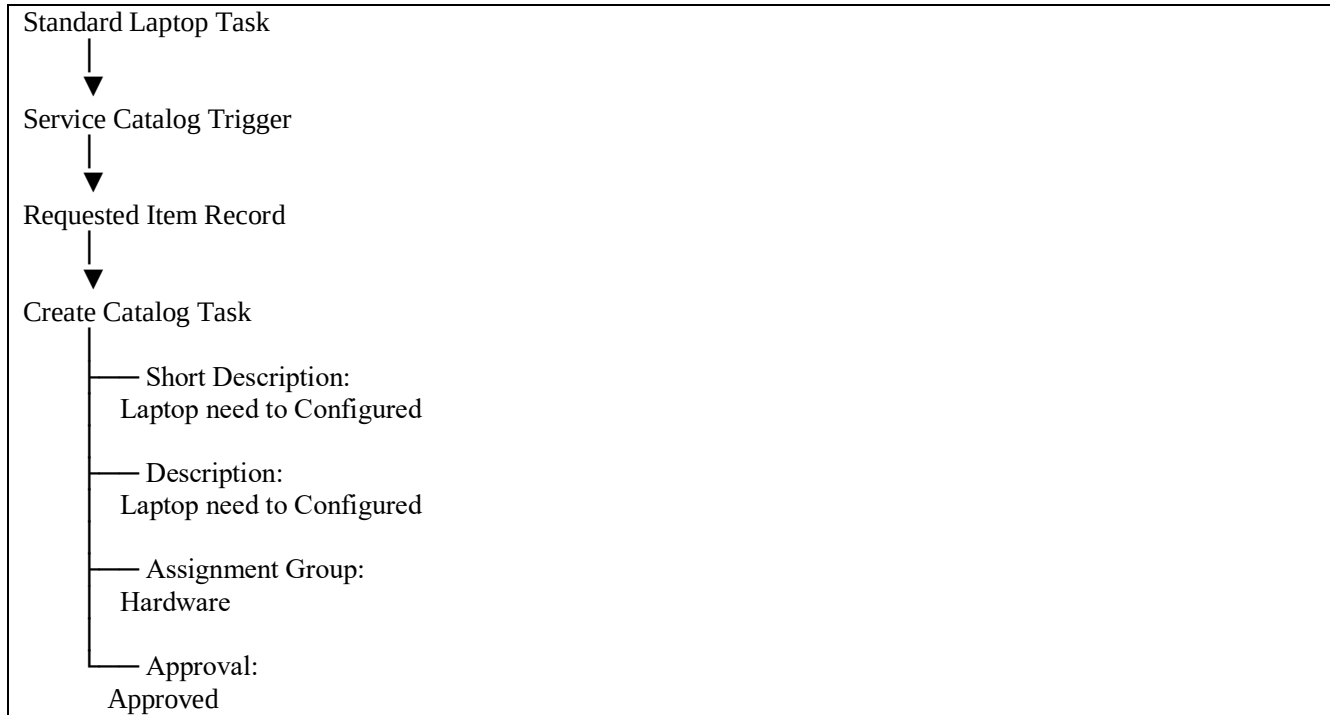
Configuration

9. Open ServiceNow.
10. Navigate to All → Flow Designer.
11. Select New → Flow.
12. Enter the flow name as Standard Laptop Task.
13. Select Global as the application.
14. Select System user as the Run As user.
15. Submit the flow.
16. Add a Service Catalog trigger.

17. Add the Create Catalog Task action.
18. Select the Requested Item Record as the Request Item.
19. Set the short description to Laptop need to Configured.
20. Add the description value as Laptop need to Configured.
21. Set the Assignment Group to Hardware.
22. Set Approval to Approved.
23. Save the flow.
24. Activate the flow.

5. Configuration Structure

Flow Structure



Service Catalog Structure





6. Running the Application

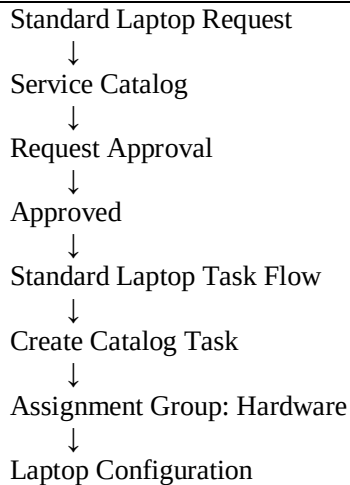
Since this project is implemented in ServiceNow, it does not require local commands such as npm start.

Running the Flow

25. Open the ServiceNow instance.
26. Navigate to Flow Designer.
27. Open Standard Laptop Task.
28. Verify that the flow is activated.
29. Navigate to Service Catalog.
30. Select Hardware.
31. Select Standard Laptop.
32. Click Order Now.
33. Submit the request.
34. Open the Request Number.
35. Navigate to the Approvers section.
36. Approve the request.
37. Open the Requested Item.
38. Scroll to the Catalog Tasks section.
39. Open the generated Catalog Task.
40. Verify the short description and Assignment Group.

7. Workflow Documentation

Workflow



Catalog Task Details

Field	Value
Action	Create Catalog Task
Request Item	Requested Item Record
Table	Catalog Task
Short Description	Laptop need to Configured
Description	Laptop need to Configured
Assignment Group	Hardware

Approval	Approved
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8. Authentication and Access

The project uses the access and authentication mechanisms provided by the ServiceNow platform.

The Flow Designer flow is configured with Run As: System user. This allows the configured flow to perform the required automated action after the Service Catalog process reaches the appropriate state.

Users access the ServiceNow instance through their authorized accounts and use the available Service Catalog and related functions according to their assigned permissions.

9. User Interface

The project uses the standard ServiceNow user interface.

- Flow Designer – Creating the Standard Laptop Task flow and configuring the trigger and Create Catalog Task action.
- Maintain Items – Opening the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item and configuring the Process Engine.
- Service Catalog – Opening Hardware, selecting Standard Laptop, and selecting Order Now.
- Request Record – Viewing the request number and checking the Approvers section.
- Requested Item – Opening the Requested Item and viewing the Catalog Tasks section.
- Catalog Task – Checking the updated short description and Hardware assignment.

10. Testing

The project can be tested by placing a Standard Laptop request and verifying whether the automation works correctly.

Test Procedure

41. Open Service Catalog.
42. Navigate to Hardware.
43. Select Standard Laptop.
44. Click Order Now.
45. Open the generated Request Number.
46. Open the Approvers section.
47. Approve the request.
48. Open the Requested Item.
49. Navigate to Catalog Tasks.
50. Open the generated Catalog Task.
51. Verify the task details.

Expected Result

The system should automatically create a Catalog Task after the request is approved.

- Short Description: Laptop need to Configured
- Description: Laptop need to Configured
- Assignment Group: Hardware
- Approval: Approved

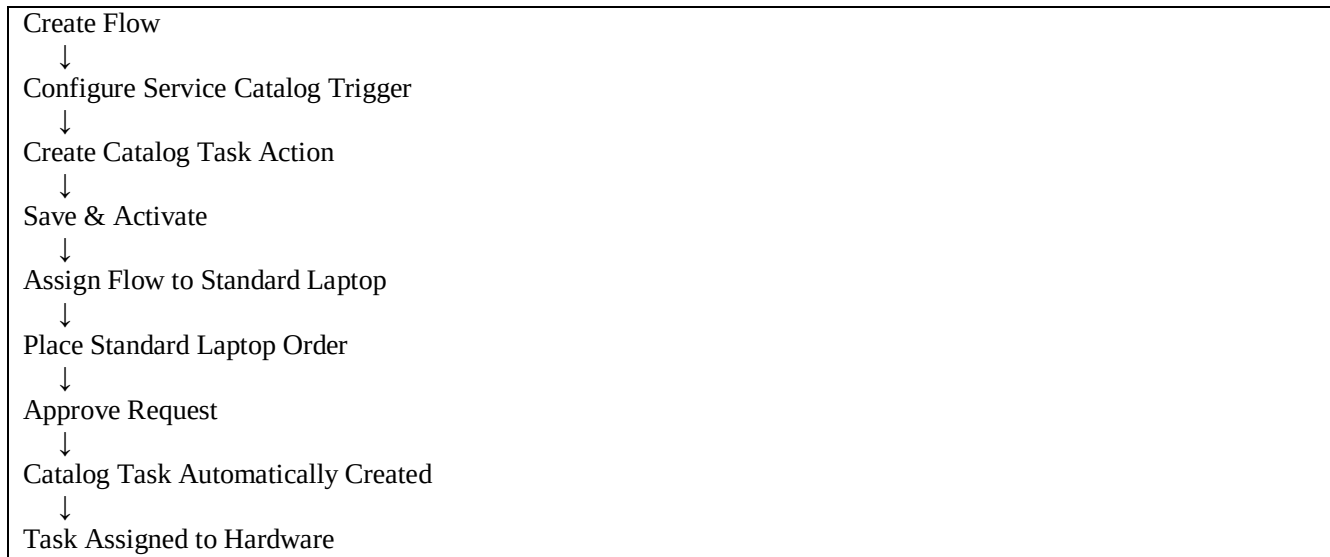
11. Screenshots or Demo

The project demonstration should include screenshots showing:

- Flow Designer home/interface.

- Standard Laptop Task flow properties.
- Service Catalog trigger.
- Create Catalog Task action.
- Short Description configuration.
- Description configuration.
- Hardware Assignment Group.
- Approved value.
- Activated flow.
- Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.
- Process Engine / Flow assignment.
- Standard Laptop Order Now page.
- Request Number.
- Approvers section.
- Requested Item.
- Catalog Tasks section.
- Final Catalog Task showing the updated description and Hardware assignment.

Demonstration Flow



12. Known Issues

- Manual processing can cause delays if automation is not configured correctly.
- Configuration tasks may be overlooked when the process depends on manual task creation.
- Incorrect flow configuration can prevent the Catalog Task from being created.
- Incorrect Assignment Group configuration may send the task to the wrong team.
- The Standard Laptop Service Catalog item must be correctly associated with the Standard Laptop Task flow.
- The flow must be activated for the automation to execute.

13. Future Enhancements

- Adding automated notifications to users when the laptop request is approved.
- Sending notifications to the Hardware team when a new configuration task is created.
- Adding automatic status updates for laptop configuration.
- Adding additional conditions for different laptop types.

- Adding automated reminders for pending configuration tasks.
- Providing better request tracking for users.
- Generating reports to monitor laptop procurement and configuration performance.
- Extending the automation to other IT hardware requests.
- Adding escalation mechanisms for delayed configuration tasks.
- Integrating additional procurement activities into the automated workflow.

Conclusion

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow Flow Designer, the project addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. The automated workflow ensures that approved Standard Laptop requests result in a Catalog Task being created and assigned to the Hardware group for configuration.

This streamlined process helps ensure timely laptop configuration, reduces user waiting time, improves resource utilisation, and enhances overall productivity within the IT procurement process.